

Identifying and addressing nonadherence risk with a technology-supported pharmacist-led risk stratification process at a health-system specialty pharmacy



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Background

- Health-system specialty pharmacy (HSSP) teams within specialty clinics are often responsible for providing care to high-volume patient populations.¹⁻³
- Leveraging technology platforms and utilizing risk stratification models can allow HSSP teams to focus their time on supporting rheumatoid arthritis (RA) patients at risk of nonadherence.¹⁻³

Objective

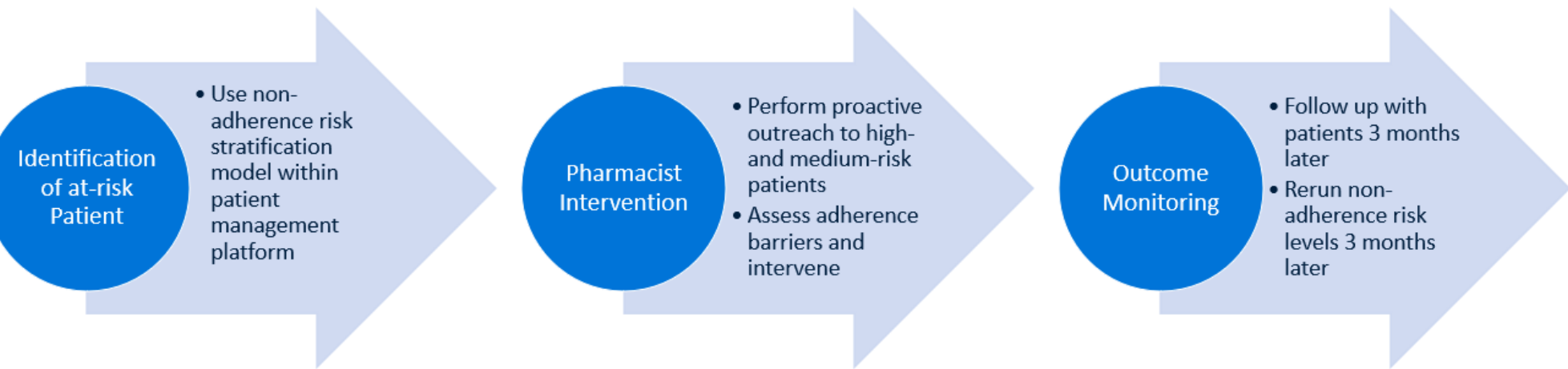
To describe a technology-supported risk stratification model utilized by HSSP teams in providing targeted adherence support to patients with RA at risk of nonadherence, and to observe adherence risk barriers and outcomes.

Methods

Study Design

This prospective pilot study was conducted at Penn State Health Specialty Pharmacy from May 2024 to February 2025. A risk stratification model built into TherigySTM® patient management platform was used to identify and classify enrolled RA patients in specialty services as low, medium, or high risk of nonadherence.

Study Protocols



Endpoints



Results

Table 1: High-Risk & Medium-Risk Patient Demographics

Patient Cohort	N=34
Mean age (years)	54.5
Female	76%
Male	24%

Figure 2: Identified Problems in High-Risk & Medium-Risk Patients

Proactive patient outreach by pharmacists provides targeted adherence support to patients with RA at risk of nonadherence.

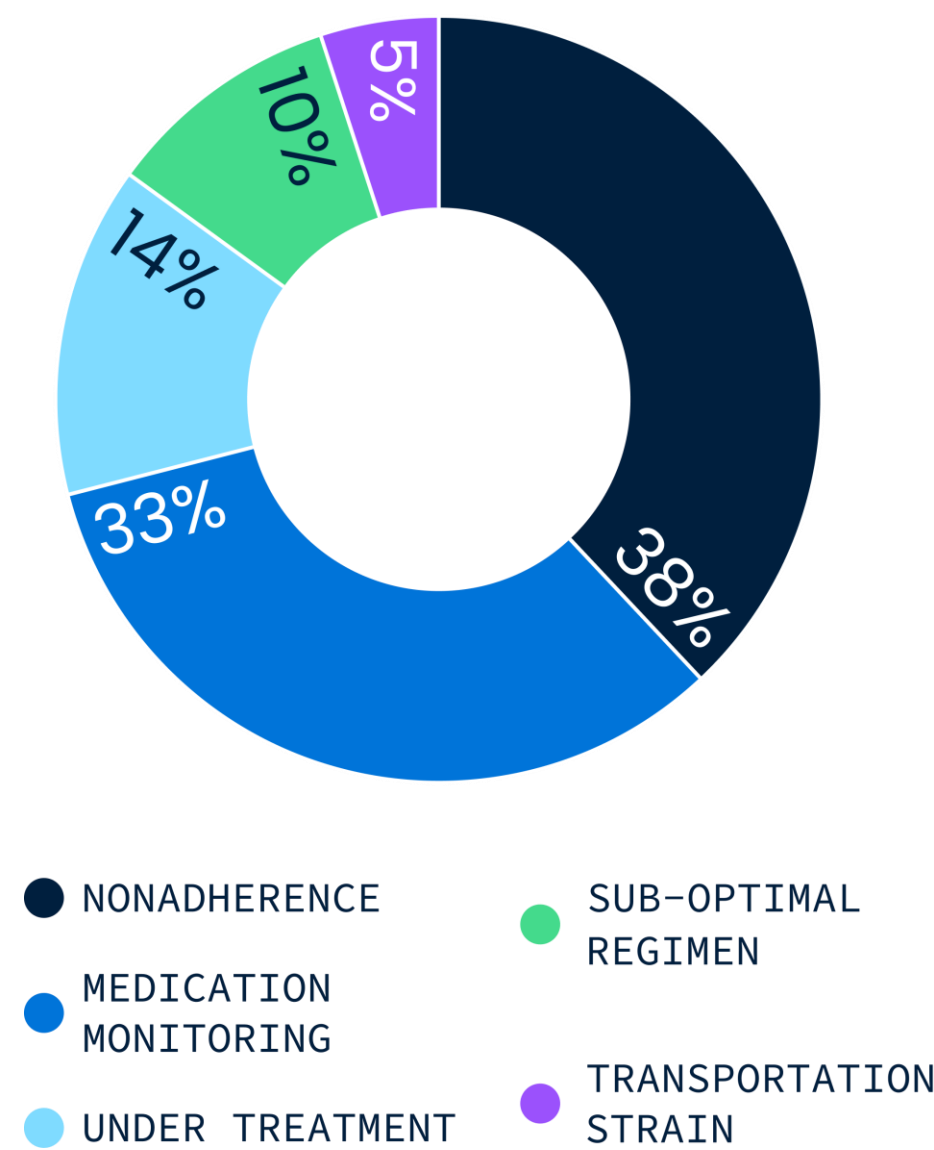
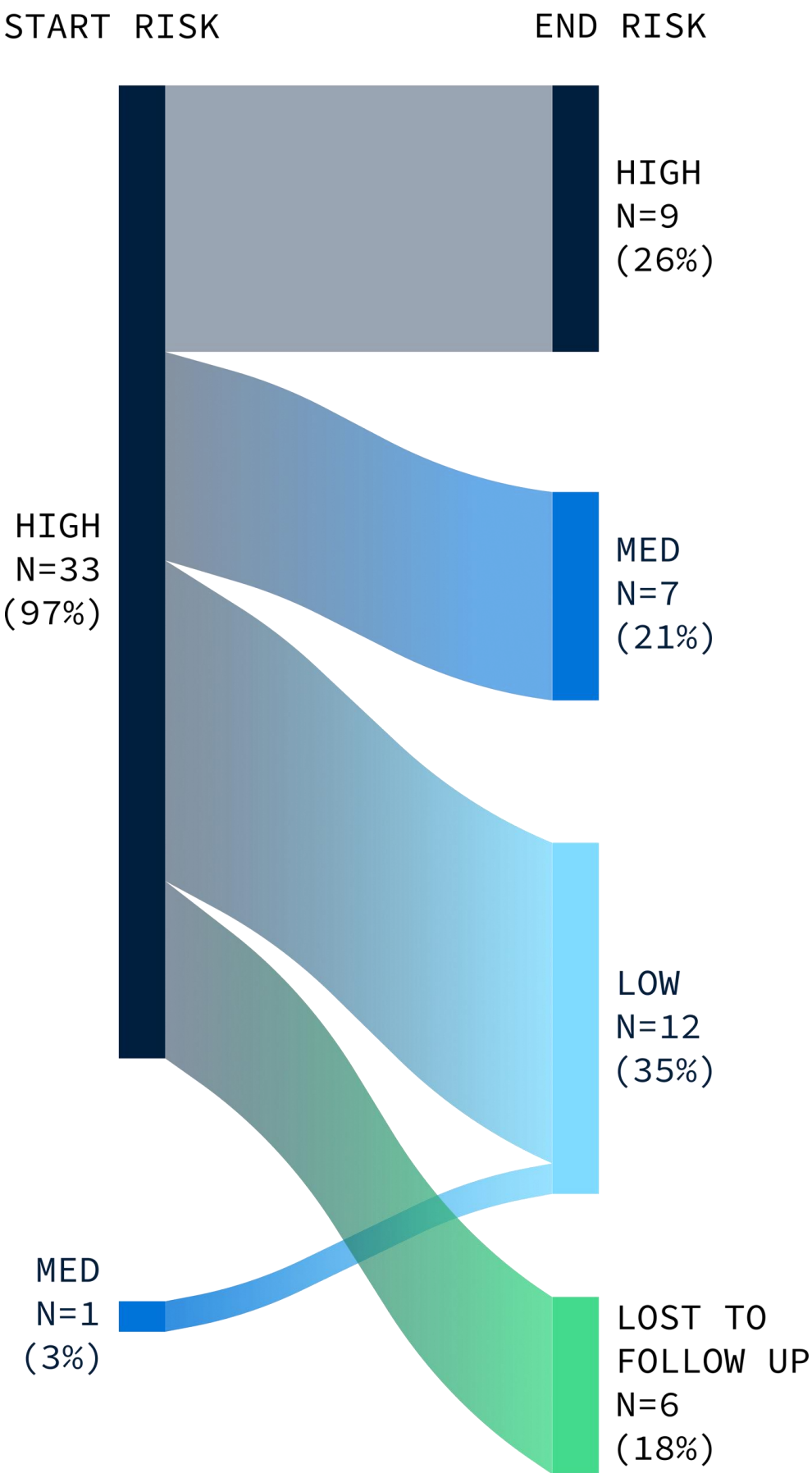
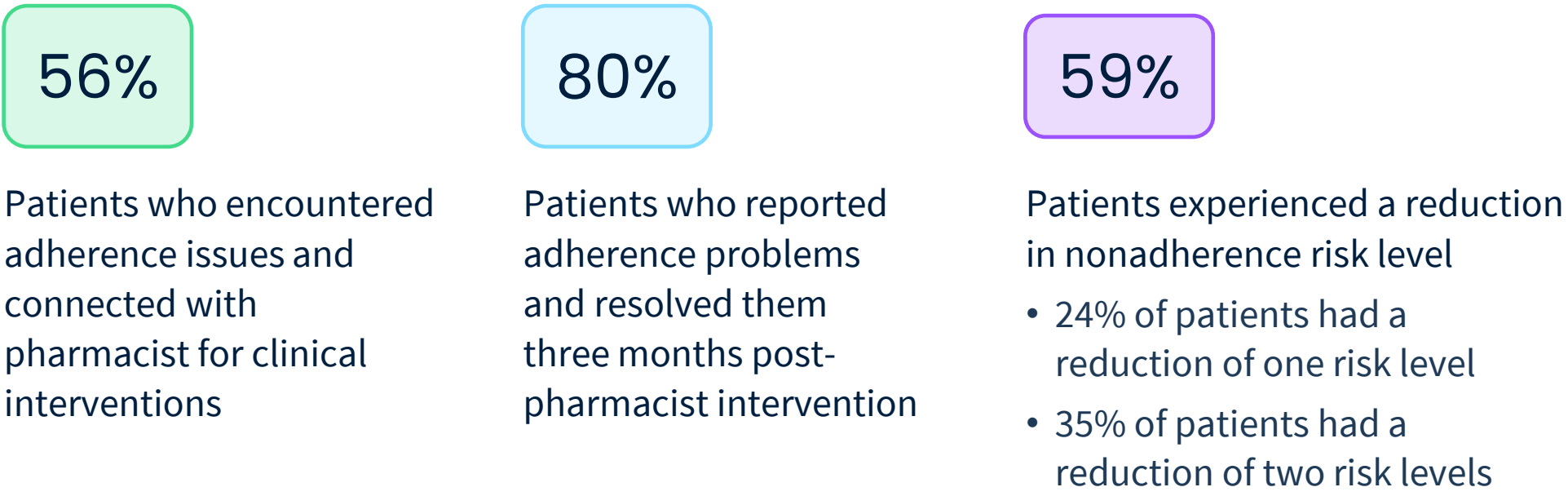


Figure 1: Changes in Nonadherence Risk After 3 Months



Results Cont.

Figure 3: Nonadherence Management Outcomes



Discussion & Conclusion

- The technology-driven process for identifying patients at risk of nonadherence plays an important role in supporting pharmacists in triaging, assessing, and addressing barriers.
- The proactive pharmacist interventions for patients most at risk provided adherence support for specialty patients by reducing nonadherence risks and mitigating barriers.
- By providing tailored recommendations based on patient-specific factors, pharmacists can play a significant role in addressing and preventing nonadherence in RA patients, potentially before adherence drops significantly.

Next Steps

- This model and process could benefit patients with other chronic conditions, including those receiving treatment for dermatologic conditions, inflammatory bowel diseases, or other inflammatory arthritis conditions.

References

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- ² Kim J, Combs K, Downs J, Tillman F. Medication adherence: the elephant in the room. *US Pharm*. 2018;43(1)30-34.
- ³ Oshotse C, Zullig LL, Bosworth HB, Tu P, Lin C. Self-efficacy and adherence behaviors in rheumatoid arthritis patients. *Prev Chronic Dis*. 2018;15:e127. doi: 10.5888/pcd15.180218